

This Patient Group Direction (PGD) is intended only for registered healthcare professionals who have been named and authorised by their organisation to practice under it.

Patient Group Direction

for the administration of Salbutamol 100mcg MDI inhaler and Prednisolone 5mg tablets for the treatment of Asthma Rescue

Patient Group Direction, version 005, issued 11 September 2026. Supersedes Version 004, 10 September 2026.

Summary of NICE / NICE CKS Guidelines for Asthma Rescue

Asthma Overview

- **Definition:** Chronic inflammatory condition of the airways presenting with recurrent episodes of wheezing, breathlessness, chest tightness, and cough.
- **Diagnosis:** Based on clinical history and pulmonary function testing (spirometry); must be confirmed prior to this PGD.

Acute Exacerbation Assessment

- **Features of acute exacerbation:** Worsening breathlessness, wheezing, cough, chest tightness not relieved by usual reliever therapy.
- **Severity assessment:** Mild-moderate exacerbation (able to complete sentences), versus severe (unable to speak full sentences, distress, low oxygen saturation).
- **Red flags:** Silent chest, exhaustion, confusion, or hypoxia warrant emergency referral.

Rescue Treatment

- **Short-acting beta-2 agonist (SABA):** First-line for acute symptom relief (salbutamol).
- **Oral corticosteroids:** For acute exacerbations to reduce airway inflammation (prednisolone).
- **Response monitoring:** Assess response at 15-30 minutes; if insufficient relief, refer for emergency assessment.

Patient Group Direction

for the supply/administration of

Salbutamol 100mcg MDI inhaler

for the treatment of

Asthma Rescue

Healthcare professionals covered and training

	Healthcare professionals allowed to work under this PGD and requirements
Qualifications and Registration	• Pharmacist registered and practicing with the GPhC • Pharmacy technician registered and practicing with the GPhC
Training and assessment	Pharmacists and Pharmacy Technicians must have completed training relevant to this condition to use this PGD. This training will be documented and overseen by the Get Real Health team. • All users must be familiar with the SPC for the products as well as BNF advice and any applicable national guidelines • All users must previously have used PGDs to supply medication • Must work in compliance with the SOPs of their own employer • All users must have appropriate indemnity in place to cover this service
Further training and responsibilities	• All users must be up to date with CPD requirements and appraisal • All users must be up to date with MHRA and safety alerts with regards to medical products • All users must understand the concepts of capacity and consent and be aware of the Mental Capacity Act 2005.

PGD Indication	Acute symptom relief in adults with diagnosed asthma presenting with acute exacerbation (breathlessness, wheezing, chest tightness)
Inclusion criteria	Adults aged 18 years and over Confirmed diagnosis of asthma, DOCUMENTED: GP record, a repeat prescription for an asthma inhaler, or an asthma action plan. Previous inhaler use on its own is not confirmation. Current preventer (inhaled corticosteroid) therapy asked about and recorded. A patient with no preventer, or who has needed more than one rescue course in the last 12 months, is referred to the GP for review; no more than one rescue course in 12 months is supplied under this PGD. Acute exacerbation with symptoms of bronchospasm (wheezing, breathlessness, chest tightness) Capable of using inhaler device or willing to use spacer Capable of giving valid informed consent
Exclusion criteria	Known hypersensitivity to salbutamol or other beta-2 agonists Acute severe or life-threatening asthma: any of unable to complete sentences in one breath, respiratory rate 25/min or more, heart rate 110/min or more, PEF 33 to 50% of best or predicted, SpO2 below 92%, silent chest, cyanosis, exhaustion, confusion or poor respiratory

	effort. Refer for emergency assessment (999 where life-threatening). Do not supply. Pulse oximetry, respiratory rate and pulse must be measured and recorded before any supply; where a peak flow meter is available, record PEF. If any observation is missing, do not supply. First presentation suggestive of asthma without prior diagnosis - refer for assessment
Cautions	Cardiovascular disease: beta-2 agonists can increase heart rate and blood pressure Diabetes mellitus: monitor blood glucose (hyperglycaemia can occur) Hyperthyroidism: beta-2 agonists can worsen symptoms Hypokalaemia: may be worsened by beta-2 agonists; monitor potassium levels Pregnancy: salbutamol is safe but ensure appropriate informed consent
Actions if patient is excluded or declines treatment	Advise on alternative treatment options and how these can be accessed. Document any advice given and the decision reached. Inform or refer to the GP as appropriate.

Details of the medicine

Name, form and strength of medicine	Salbutamol 100mcg metered-dose inhaler (MDI)
Legal category	POM
Storage	Store below 25°C. Keep away from heat and direct sunlight. Shake well before each use.
Route/method of administration	Inhalation via MDI, with or without spacer
Dose and frequency	2-4 puffs as required for acute symptom relief Initial dose: 2-4 puffs inhaled immediately for acute exacerbation Use spacer device in less experienced patients to optimise drug delivery May repeat after 15-30 minutes if inadequate response
Quantity to be administered and/or supplied	1 MDI inhaler (200 doses)
Maximum or minimum treatment period	As needed during acute exacerbation
Adverse effects	Common: tremor (fine tremor of hands), headache, nervousness, tachycardia

	Uncommon: palpitations, muscle cramps, anxiety Rare: hypersensitivity reactions, arrhythmias, myocardial ischaemia
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Yellow card reporting	Report suspected adverse effects via https://yellowcard.mhra.gov.uk and inform the GP as appropriate.
Records to be kept	Record the following information: • that valid informed consent was given • name of individual, address, date of birth and GP • name of healthcare practitioner • name and brand of medication • date of supply dose, form and route quantity supplied • advice given, including advice given if excluded or declines treatment • details of any adverse drug reactions and actions taken supplied via PGD Records should be signed and dated. All records should be clear, legible and contemporaneous. Electronic records can be made. A record of all individuals receiving treatment under this PGD should also be kept for audit purposes as follows: • Adults aged 18 years and over - keep records for 8 years • Children aged under 18 years - keep records until the 25th birthday (if the patient was 17 years when treatment was finished, keep records until the 26th birthday)

Patient information

Written information to be given to patient or carer	Supply the patient information leaflet (PIL) provided with each medication.
Follow-up advice to be given to patient or carer	Use the inhaler technique sheet provided to ensure optimal drug delivery. If using a MDI without a spacer, coordinate inhalation with actuation. If symptoms do not improve within 15-30 minutes of salbutamol use, seek emergency medical attention. Take the full course of prednisolone as prescribed, even if symptoms improve. Take prednisolone with food if it causes stomach upset. Do not stop prednisolone abruptly; follow the course as directed. If diabetic, monitor blood glucose more frequently as prednisolone may raise levels; inform your GP. If taking other medications, inform your healthcare provider of steroid use. Seek immediate medical attention if experiencing severe

	breathlessness, chest pain, confusion, or exhaustion during the exacerbation. Review your asthma action plan and triggers with your GP after recovery. Ensure your asthma maintenance therapy is optimised to prevent future exacerbations.
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Key references

- NICE Medicines Practice Guideline 2 (MPG2): Patient Group Directions. Published March 2017
<https://www.nice.org.uk/guidance/mg2>
- NICE MPG2 Patient group directions: competency framework for health professionals using patient group directions. Updated March 2017
<https://www.nice.org.uk/guidance/mpg2/resources>
- NICE CKS Guidance: Asthma: diagnosis and management
- British National Formulary (BNF) Key information on the selection, prescribing, dispensing and administration of medicines

Agreement to practise by the Registered Healthcare Professional

By signing this PGD you are confirming that you agree to its contents and that you will work within it. PGDs do not remove inherent professional obligations or accountability. It is the responsibility of each healthcare professional to practise only within the bounds of their own competence and professional code of conduct.

Name and address of pharmacy premises / clinic premises to which this PGD relates			
Name of healthcare professional	Job title	Registration number	Signature
Valid from date	Expiry date		

11/9/26	31/7/27		
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PGD adoption and authorisation by the employer/clinical lead

The employer has ensured that the person using this PGD, has the knowledge and skills to safely provide the service which will encompass the supply or administration of a medication or medicine.

This section must be signed by the superintendent or clinical lead responsible for this service. To be completed by the adopting pharmacy. These are the adopting organisation's own signatories and must not be Get Real Health staff.

Name of superintendent / clinical lead	Job title & name of organisation	Signature	Date
Name of professional group signatory	Job title & name of organisation	Signature	Date

Change history

Version number	Change details	Date
001	Development & issue of new PGD	1st November 2025

Patient Group Direction

for the supply/administration of

Prednisolone 5mg tablets

for the treatment of

Asthma Rescue

Healthcare professionals covered and training

	Healthcare professionals allowed to work under this PGD and requirements
Qualifications and Registration	• Pharmacist registered and practicing with the GPhC • Pharmacy technician registered and practicing with the GPhC
Training and assessment	Pharmacists and Pharmacy Technicians must have completed training relevant to this condition to use this PGD. This training will be documented and overseen by the Get Real Health team. • All users must be familiar with the SPC for the products as well as BNF advice and any applicable national guidelines • All users must previously have used PGDs to supply medication • Must work in compliance with the SOPs of their own employer • All users must have appropriate indemnity in place to cover this service
Further training and responsibilities	• All users must be up to date with CPD requirements and appraisal • All users must be up to date with MHRA and safety alerts with regards to medical products • All users must understand the concepts of capacity and consent and be aware of the Mental Capacity Act 2005.

PGD Indication	Treatment of acute asthma exacerbation to reduce airway inflammation and improve bronchospasm
Inclusion criteria	Adults aged 18 years and over Confirmed diagnosis of asthma MODERATE exacerbation with incomplete response to salbutamol: able to complete sentences in one breath, PEF over 50% of best or predicted where measurable, SpO2 92% or above, respiratory rate below 25, heart rate below 110, and no acute severe or life-threatening feature. Any acute severe or life-threatening feature is an emergency referral, not a prednisolone supply. Able to take oral medication No contraindications to corticosteroid use

	Capable of giving valid informed consent
Exclusion criteria	Known hypersensitivity to prednisolone or other corticosteroids Acute severe or life-threatening asthma: any of unable to complete sentences in one breath, respiratory rate 25/min or more, heart rate 110/min or more, PEF 33 to 50% of best or predicted, SpO2 below 92%, silent chest, cyanosis, exhaustion, confusion or poor respiratory effort. Refer for emergency assessment (999 where life-threatening). Do not supply. Pulse oximetry, respiratory rate and pulse must be measured and recorded before any supply; where a peak flow meter is available, record PEF. If any observation is missing, do not supply. First presentation suggestive of asthma without a prior diagnosis. Refer for assessment. Systemic infection (unless treated with appropriate antimicrobials) Vaccination with live vaccines during treatment Severe hepatic dysfunction Uncontrolled hypertension or cardiac disease (relative - discuss risk/benefit)
Cautions	Diabetes mellitus: corticosteroids can increase blood glucose; monitor BM and adjust diabetes medication if needed Osteoporosis or risk factors: short-term treatment risk is low but inform patient Peptic ulcer disease or GI upset: consider gastroprotection Psychiatric history: corticosteroids can cause mood changes, insomnia, or exacerbate existing conditions Renal impairment: generally safe for short-term use Hypertension: may worsen; monitor blood pressure Infections: can mask symptoms; ensure appropriate investigation before use Pregnancy and breastfeeding: generally safe for acute use; discuss benefits/risks
Actions if patient is excluded or declines treatment	Advise on alternative treatment options and how these can be accessed. Document any advice given and the decision reached. Inform or refer to the GP as appropriate.

Details of the medicine

Name, form and strength of medicine	Prednisolone 5mg tablets
Legal category	POM

Storage	Store below 25°C. Keep in original container. Protect from light and moisture.
Route/method of administration	Oral
Dose and frequency	40-50mg as a single dose or in divided doses for acute exacerbation Typical: 40mg daily for 5-7 days for acute exacerbation May be taken with food to reduce GI upset Prednisolone 5mg tablets: 40mg daily is EIGHT tablets a day and 50mg daily is TEN tablets a day. Eight to ten tablets is one day of treatment, not a course.
Quantity to be administered and/or supplied	40 tablets of 5mg for 40mg daily for 5 days. Where the course is 7 days or the dose is 50mg, supply the number of tablets the course needs, to a maximum of 70 (50mg daily for 7 days). Check the arithmetic against the dose before supply.
Maximum or minimum treatment period	5-7 days for acute exacerbation
Adverse effects	Very common: insomnia, mood changes (euphoria, irritability, anxiety), increased appetite Common: GI upset (dyspepsia, nausea), increased sweating, headache, dizziness Uncommon: acne, facial flushing, restlessness, hypertension, hyperglycaemia, immunosuppression Rare: adrenal suppression (with prolonged use), osteoporosis, avascular necrosis, psychiatric disturbances, opportunistic infections

Yellow card reporting	Report suspected adverse effects via https://yellowcard.mhra.gov.uk and inform the GP as appropriate.
Records to be kept	Record the following information: • that valid informed consent was given • name of individual, address, date of birth and GP • name of healthcare practitioner • name and brand of medication • date of supply dose, form and route quantity supplied • advice given, including advice given if excluded or declines treatment • details of any adverse drug reactions and actions taken supplied via PGD Records should be signed and dated. All records should be clear, legible and contemporaneous. Electronic records can be made. A record of all individuals receiving treatment under this PGD should also be kept for audit purposes as follows:

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Key references

- NICE Medicines Practice Guideline 2 (MPG2): Patient Group Directions. Published March 2017 <https://www.nice.org.uk/guidance/mg2>
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Name of professional group signatory	Job title & name of organisation	Signature	Date

Change history

Version number	Change details	Date
001	Development & issue of new PGD	1st November 2025

Version and change record

Version: v005

Issued: 11 September 2026

Supersedes: Version 004, 10 September 2026

Valid from: 11 September 2026. Expiry: 31 July 2027. These dates govern this version and supersede any earlier date printed elsewhere in this document.

Changes in this version:

Structural clean-up applied to every live Get Real Health PGD on 11 September 2026, following the adversarial review of 10 September: the adopting pharmacy's authorisation block is blank, for the pharmacy's own signatories; one signed authorisation page for this version replaces the earlier signature blocks; every validity cell states this version's dates (valid from 11 September 2026, expiry 31 July 2027); narration about earlier versions, the consultation tool and individual customers is removed from the body of the document; the change records of earlier reissues are carried below as previous version records. No clinical criterion changes unless listed.

Previous version records

Version: v002

Issued: 9 September 2026

Supersedes: the previous signed version of this document, and any correction notice attached to it.

Change: The prednisolone arm stated "for 5-7 day course: 8-10 tablets of 5mg" and, two lines later, "up to 42 tablets". Eight to ten tablets is a single day at 40 to 50mg. The quantity is now stated from the dose: 40 tablets for 40mg daily for 5 days, to a maximum of 70 for 50mg daily for 7 days. The emergency red flags in the salbutamol arm, hypoxia, silent chest, exhaustion, confusion and first presentation, were not in the prednisolone arm's exclusions. They are now. This incorporates and withdraws the correction notice of 7 September 2026. The salbutamol arm is unchanged.

Authorised by Nitin Shori, Medical Director (GMC 6047293) and Chris Pilkington, Head Pharmacist (GPhC 2046322), on 9 September 2026. Signatures applied digitally on their joint instruction, which is the established process for Get Real Health PGDs.

Version: v003

Issued: 10 September 2026

Supersedes: Version 002, 9 September 2026

Valid from: 10 September 2026. Expiry: 31 July 2027. These dates govern this version and supersede any earlier date printed elsewhere in this document.

Changes in this version:

Validity: this version is valid from 10 September 2026 and expires on 31 July 2027. The signed master previously stated no period of validity, or an expiry of 31 October 2026; those are superseded. The expiry cells read 31 October 2026.

Exclusion criteria, both arms: the previous version excluded a severe attack only where SpO2 was below 92%, which is the life-threatening threshold. The BTS/SIGN acute severe criteria (cannot complete sentences, RR 25 or more, HR 110 or more, PEF 33 to 50%) now exclude, and pulse oximetry, respiratory rate and pulse must be measured and recorded before any supply.

Version: v004

Issued: 10 September 2026

Supersedes: Version 003, 10 September 2026

Valid from: 10 September 2026. Expiry: 31 July 2027. These dates govern this version and supersede any earlier date printed elsewhere in this document.

Changes in this version:

Salbutamol arm: 'previous inhaler use' no longer counts as a confirmed diagnosis, which contradicted the guidance summary and the exclusion for first presentation. A documented diagnosis is required; preventer therapy is recorded; a patient with no preventer or more than one rescue course in 12 months is referred to the GP for review.

Prednisolone arm: 'inadequately responsive to SABA alone' was both the entry criterion here and an emergency-referral trigger in the guidance summary. The arm now defines the moderate exacerbation it treats (able to complete sentences, PEF over 50%, SpO2 92% or above, RR under 25, HR under 110, no severe feature); anything meeting the acute severe criteria is referred.

Signed on behalf of Get Real Health

Version v005, 11 September 2026.

Name	Qualification	Signature	Date
Nitin Shori	Medical Director GMC: 6047293		11 September 2026
Chris Pilkington	Head Pharmacist GPhC: 2046322		11 September 2026

Both authorising signatories reviewed this version together on 11 September 2026 and gave their authorisation for it to be issued. Signatures were applied digitally on their joint instruction, which is the established process for Get Real Health PGDs. This version is not valid without both signatures.